

PISCINES NOVO — POOL CLOSING PROCEDURES

Rules for Every Pool Closing

Before starting, identify:

- Pool type
- Number of skimmers and returns
- Bottom-drain configuration
- Heater, salt system and water features
- Underground plumbing or backwash lines
- Whether a winter cover is included
- Whether the pump is plugged in or hardwired

Take pictures of any existing damage, cracked fittings, glued parts or unusual plumbing before touching them.

Important Safety Rules

- Never disconnect a hardwired pump or electrical wiring.
- Never force a glued, cracked or damaged fitting.
- Never leave water trapped inside equipment, valves or plumbing.
- Blow each separate line individually whenever possible.
- The heater must always be blown out separately.
- Do not overpressurize plumbing.
- Keep every drain plug, gasket, screw and small part together.
- Take final pictures before leaving.

1. ABOVE-GROUND LINER POOL

Step 1 — Determine Whether a Cover Is Being Installed

When Installing a Cover

The cover must be installed **before lowering the water**.

1. Remove the stairs or ladder.
2. Remove any bricks or weights before lifting the stairs.
3. Do not allow weights to fall into the pool.
4. Install the skimmer foam kit.
5. Remove the return fitting.
6. Install and secure the winter cover.
7. Place the submersible pump and begin lowering the water.

When No Cover Is Being Installed

1. Place the submersible pump immediately.
2. Begin lowering the water.
3. Remove the stairs while the pool drains.

Leave the stairs neatly on the deck unless the customer requests another location.

Step 2 — Lower the Water

Stop the water approximately:

8 inches below the return opening.

Measure from the return, not from the skimmer.

Do not drain the pool lower than necessary.

Step 3 — Isolate the Bottom Drain

If the pool has a bottom drain:

1. Move the valve below the skimmer to isolate the bottom-drain line.
2. Confirm that water will not rush back through the plumbing.
3. Keep the valve in the required position while disconnecting equipment.

The valve may need to be moved again when adding antifreeze.

Step 4 — Remove the Plumbing and Equipment

Remove all exposed plumbing that is designed to come apart, including:

- Flexible hoses
- Pump connections
- Filter connections
- Salt cell
- Removable three-way valves
- Heater connections, when removable

Underground plumbing remains installed and must be blown out.

Leave all removed valves open so water cannot remain trapped inside them.

Step 5 — Drain the Equipment

Pump

- Remove the pump drain plugs.
- Empty the pump completely.
- Place plugs and gaskets inside the pump basket or lid.
- Advise the customer to store the pump in the garage.

Sand Filter

Remove:

- Filter drain plug
- Pressure gauge
- Backwash sight glass
- Black sight-glass gasket

Do not force out a pressure gauge that is heavily glued, cracked or likely to break. Leave it installed and take a picture.

Heater

- Disconnect removable unions.
- Remove the heater drain plug, when present.
- Blow the heater out separately.
- Leave the heater outside.

Salt System

- Remove and drain the salt cell.
- Advise the customer to store it inside.

If there is a flow switch:

- The wire may be disconnected from the control board.
- Do not unscrew the flow switch.
- Leave it installed in the plumbing.
- Wrap the wire neatly around the nearby hose.

Step 6 — Blow Out Fixed Plumbing

Blow out:

- Underground plumbing
- Underground backwash lines
- Heater plumbing
- Any line that cannot be physically removed

Continue until the line is cleared of water.

Step 7 — Winterize the Bottom Drain

1. Pour pool antifreeze into the bottom-drain line.
2. Continue until antifreeze becomes visible coming from the bottom-drain cover inside the pool.
3. Close the bottom-drain valve.
4. Insert a foam noodle into the accessible valve opening.
5. Secure it so water cannot push it out.
6. Leave enough exposed so it can be removed during the opening.

Step 8 — Add the Closing Kit

Add the winter closing kit after the water has been lowered.

Distribute it around the pool according to the required dosage.

Step 9 — Store the Equipment

Place removed equipment neatly beside the shed, garage or customer-approved location.

Preferably store inside:

- Pump
- Salt cell
- Pressure gauge
- Small parts and gaskets

The sand filter and heater normally stay outside.

Step 10 — Final Pictures and Inspection

Take:

1. One wide picture of the completed pool
2. One clear picture showing the skimmer, return and final water level
3. Pictures of any damaged or unusual equipment

Confirm:

- Water is 8 inches below the return.
- Stairs are removed.
- Equipment is drained.
- Underground lines are blown.
- Bottom drain is protected.
- Winter kit is added.

- Cover is secured, when included.
 - Work area is clean.
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2. IN-GROUND LINER POOL

Step 1 — Lower the Water

Place the submersible pump immediately.

Stop the water when it reaches:

The height of the first pool step.

Do not use the returns as the water-level reference.

The winter cover is installed at the end.

Step 2 — Remove Poolside Fittings

While the water lowers, remove:

- All return fittings
- Stair jet fittings
- Water-feature fittings
- Skimmer basket

The skimmer flap can remain installed.

Store all return fittings inside the skimmer basket. Leave the basket beside the equipment when finished.

For threaded winter plugs:

- Old Teflon tape does not need to be fully removed.
- Add new Teflon tape over it.
- Wrap the tape in the direction the plug tightens.

Step 3 — Blow Out Every Return Separately

1. Plug every return except one.
2. Blow the single open return until only air or mist exits.
3. Plug that return.
4. Open the next return.
5. Repeat until every return is individually blown and plugged.

Follow the same procedure for:

- Stair jets
- Fountains
- Waterfalls
- Other water features

Do not blow several openings at once when they can be separated.

Step 4 — Blow Out the Skimmer

The skimmer is normally blown from the plumbing in front of the pump.

1. Isolate the skimmer line.
2. Blow until mostly air or mist comes from the skimmer.
3. When a valve is available, it may be briefly closed and reopened to create a controlled burst.
4. Do not excessively pressurize the line.

Step 5 — Blow Out the Bottom Drain

Separate Bottom-Drain Line

1. Isolate the bottom-drain line.
2. Blow until strong bubbles appear from the bottom drain.
3. Close the valve while air is still flowing to create an air lock.

If there is no valve, blow until strong bubbles appear and clear the line as completely as possible.

Bottom Drain Connected Through the Skimmer

1. Wait until the water is below the bottom-drain inlet inside the skimmer.
2. Insert approximately three feet of foam noodle into the inlet.
3. Do not push it so deeply that it cannot be removed.
4. Plug the inlet.
5. Plug the skimmer line.
6. Add approximately half a bottle of pool antifreeze.

Step 6 — Protect Every Skimmer

Every skimmer must have:

- A proper Gizmo, or
- A complete skimmer foam kit in good condition

Do not accept:

- Random bottles

- Broken foam
- Half foam blocks
- Damaged Gizmos
- Foam that will float out

If the existing protection is damaged, install a Gizmo.

After the line is blown and plugged:

1. Add approximately half a bottle of pool antifreeze.
2. Install the Gizmo or proper foam kit.
3. Wrap the skimmer lid in a plastic bag.
4. Reinstall the lid securely.

Repeat for every skimmer.

Step 7 — Prepare the Pool Lights

Remove accessible deep-end lights that are designed to be removed.

- Do not damage the cable.
- Do not lose the retaining screw.
- Store the screw inside the pump basket.
- Do not open electrical connections.

If the light cannot be safely removed, leave it and document the condition.

Step 8 — Blow Out the Equipment Lines

When possible, disconnect the plumbing leading toward the filter.

Use the multiport valve as required:

- **Waste:** Blow out the backwash line.
- **Recirculate:** Blow toward the returns.

The technician at the pool must still blow each return separately.

Do not move the multiport handle while the system is pressurized.

Step 9 — Blow Out the Heater Separately

The heater must be blown out directly. Blowing only through the filter is not enough.

1. Turn the heater off.
2. Disconnect removable heater unions.
3. Blow through the heater separately.

4. Remove the heater drain plug, when present.
5. Move bypass valves through their positions to release trapped water.
6. Leave appropriate valves open after the blowout.

Do not force unions that are glued, damaged or not designed to disconnect.

Step 10 — Drain the Equipment

Pump

- Remove all pump drain plugs.
- Empty the pump and basket area.
- Store plugs in the pump basket.

Only remove the pump when:

- It plugs into a wall outlet.
- It has removable unions.
- No electrical wiring must be disconnected.

Never remove a hardwired pump, even if the customer asks.

Sand Filter

Remove:

- Filter drain plug
- Pressure gauge
- Backwash sight glass
- Black sight-glass gasket

Do not force damaged or glued parts.

Salt System

- Remove and drain the salt cell.
- Store removable parts safely.

For a flow switch:

- Disconnect the wire from the board only when necessary.
- Do not unscrew the flow switch.
- Leave it installed.
- Wrap the wire around the nearby hose.

Drain all other equipment, including chlorinators, booster pumps and water-feature systems.

Step 11 — Set the Valves

- Move every valve through its positions to remove hidden water.
- Leave valves open whenever possible.
- Leave the bottom-drain valve closed when required to maintain its air lock.
- Do not trap water between two closed valves.

Step 12 — Add the Closing Kit

Once the water reaches the first step:

- Add the winter closing kit.
- Distribute it around the pool.
- Do not allow concentrated chemicals to sit directly on the liner.

Step 13 — Install the Cover Last

After all lines and equipment are winterized:

1. Position the rectangular cover evenly.
2. Secure it using yellow rope and yellow stakes or picks.
3. Secure all sides.
4. Do not attach ropes to fragile plumbing or equipment.
5. Avoid loose sections and tripping hazards.

Step 14 — Final Pictures and Inspection

Take pictures showing:

- Final water level at the first step
- Every skimmer
- Plugged returns
- Equipment area
- Installed cover
- Existing damage or unusual plumbing

Confirm:

- Every return was blown separately.
- Skimmer and bottom drain were blown.
- Every skimmer has proper protection.
- Heater was blown separately.
- Drain plugs were removed.
- Hardwired equipment was not disconnected.
- Cover is secure.
- Parts are stored together.
- Work area is clean.

3. IN-GROUND CONCRETE POOL

The concrete-pool closing follows the same main procedure as an in-ground liner pool.

Step 1 — Lower the Water

Begin lowering the water immediately.

Stop when the water reaches:

The height of the first pool step.

Install the winter cover only after the closing is complete.

Step 2 — Remove Pool Fittings

Remove:

- Return fittings
- Stair jets
- Water-feature fittings
- Skimmer baskets

The skimmer flap may remain installed.

Store removed fittings inside the skimmer basket.

Step 3 — Blow Out Returns Individually

1. Plug every return except one.
2. Blow the open return until only air or mist exits.
3. Plug it.
4. Open the next return.
5. Repeat for every return.

Blow stair jets, fountains and water features separately.

Step 4 — Blow Out the Skimmer

- Isolate the skimmer line.
- Blow from the front of the pump.
- Continue until mostly air or mist exits.
- Plug the skimmer line.

Step 5 — Blow Out the Bottom Drain

For a separate bottom-drain line:

- Blow until strong bubbles appear.
- Close the valve while air is flowing to create an air lock.

For a bottom drain connected through the skimmer:

- Wait until the inlet is exposed.
- Insert approximately three feet of foam noodle.
- Plug the inlet.
- Add approximately half a bottle of pool antifreeze.

Step 6 — Protect the Skimmer

For every skimmer:

1. Add approximately half a bottle of antifreeze.
2. Install a proper Gizmo or complete foam kit.
3. Do not use broken foam or random bottles.
4. Wrap the lid in a plastic bag.
5. Reinstall the lid.

Step 7 — Prepare Lights and Water Features

- Remove accessible deep-end lights when they are designed to be removed.
- Save the retaining screw.
- Do not open electrical wiring.
- Blow out every separate water feature.

Step 8 — Winterize the Equipment

Blow out:

- Backwash line
- Return plumbing
- Skimmer line
- Bottom-drain line
- Water-feature lines
- Heater

The heater must be disconnected and blown separately whenever its unions allow it.

Remove:

- Pump drain plugs

- Filter drain plug
- Pressure gauge
- Backwash sight glass
- Sight-glass gasket
- Heater drain plug

Do not disconnect a hardwired pump.

Step 9 — Winterize the Salt System

- Remove and drain the salt cell.
- Leave the flow switch screwed into the plumbing.
- Disconnect only its wire when necessary.
- Wrap the wire around the nearby hose.

Step 10 — Set Valves and Add the Closing Kit

- Move valves through all positions.
- Leave them open so water cannot remain trapped.
- Keep the bottom-drain valve closed only to maintain an air lock.
- Add the winter closing kit once the water reaches the first step.

Step 11 — Install the Cover

Install the cover last.

- Center the cover.
- Secure it using yellow rope and stakes.
- Secure every side.
- Keep ropes away from fragile equipment and walking areas.

Step 12 — Final Pictures and Inspection

Confirm:

- Water is at the first step.
- Every line was blown separately.
- Every skimmer is protected.
- Heater was blown separately.
- Drain plugs were removed.
- Equipment is safely winterized.
- Cover is secure.
- Parts are stored.
- Property is clean.

4. FIBERGLASS POOL

The fiberglass procedure is the same as the in-ground liner procedure, except for the water level and the skimmer face plug.

Step 1 — Lower the Water

Begin lowering the water immediately.

Stop when the water is:

Just below the return openings.

Do not lower the water to the first step.

The return openings must be exposed so they can be removed, blown and plugged.

Step 2 — Prepare the Skimmer Face

A winter skimmer face plug must be installed from inside the pool.

Some fiberglass skimmers have a removable decorative or protective cover plate.

When a cover plate is present:

1. Remove the cover plate.
2. Keep its screws or parts together.
3. Clean the skimmer face if required.
4. Install the proper skimmer face plug.
5. Confirm that the plug seals the skimmer opening completely.

Do not install the winter face plug over the existing cover plate.

Step 3 — Remove Pool Fittings

Once the water is below the returns, remove:

- Return fittings
- Stair jets
- Water-feature fittings
- Skimmer basket

Store all return fittings inside the skimmer basket.

Step 4 — Blow Out Every Return Separately

1. Plug every return except one.
2. Blow the open return until only air or mist exits.
3. Plug it.
4. Open the next return.
5. Repeat until every return is complete.

Repeat for stair jets, fountains and water features.

Step 5 — Blow Out the Skimmer and Bottom Drain

Skimmer

- Isolate the skimmer line.
- Blow until mostly air or mist exits.
- Plug the plumbing line.
- Install the skimmer face plug.

Separate Bottom Drain

- Blow until strong bubbles appear.
- Close the valve while air is flowing to create an air lock.

Bottom Drain Connected Through the Skimmer

- Wait until the inlet is exposed.
- Insert approximately three feet of foam noodle.
- Plug the inlet.
- Add approximately half a bottle of pool antifreeze.

Step 6 — Protect the Skimmer

Even with a skimmer face plug:

- Add approximately half a bottle of antifreeze when required.
- Install the approved internal skimmer protection.
- Use a proper Gizmo or complete foam kit when the skimmer design requires it.
- Do not use random bottles or broken foam.
- Wrap the skimmer lid in a plastic bag and reinstall it.

Step 7 — Prepare Lights and Water Features

- Remove accessible lights that are designed to be removed.
- Save all screws.
- Do not touch electrical wiring.
- Blow every water feature separately.

Step 8 — Blow Out the Equipment

Blow out:

- Skimmer line
- Bottom-drain line
- Returns
- Backwash line
- Stair jets
- Water features
- Heater

The heater must be blown out separately by disconnecting its removable unions.

Step 9 — Drain the Equipment

Remove:

- Pump drain plugs
- Filter drain plug
- Pressure gauge
- Backwash sight glass
- Sight-glass gasket
- Heater drain plug
- Accessible equipment drain plugs

Do not disconnect a hardwired pump.

Only remove a pump when it is plugged into a wall outlet and has removable unions.

Step 10 — Winterize the Salt System

- Remove and drain the salt cell.
- Do not unscrew the flow switch.
- Disconnect only the wire when necessary.
- Wrap the wire neatly around the nearby hose.

Step 11 — Set Valves and Add the Closing Kit

- Move all valves through their positions.
- Leave them open so water cannot become trapped.
- Keep the bottom-drain valve closed when maintaining an air lock.
- Add the winter closing kit after the water is just below the returns.

Step 12 — Install the Cover Last

- Position the cover evenly.
- Secure it with the approved rope, stakes or cover system.
- Secure all sides.
- Keep ropes away from fragile plumbing and walking areas.

Step 13 — Final Pictures and Inspection

Take pictures showing:

- Water immediately below the returns
- Skimmer face plug
- Every plugged return
- Skimmer protection
- Equipment area
- Installed cover

Confirm:

- Water is just below the returns.
- Skimmer cover plate was removed when required.
- Skimmer face plug is sealed.
- Every return was blown separately.
- Bottom drain is protected.
- Heater was blown separately.
- Equipment is drained.
- Cover is secure.
- All parts are stored.
- Property is clean.

REQUIRED FINAL PHOTOS FOR EVERY CLOSING

Before leaving, take:

1. A wide picture of the completed pool
2. A clear picture showing the final water level
3. Pictures of every skimmer
4. A picture of the equipment area
5. A picture of the installed cover
6. Pictures of any damage, unusual plumbing or parts left installed

Do not close the job until the pictures clearly show that the correct procedure was completed.